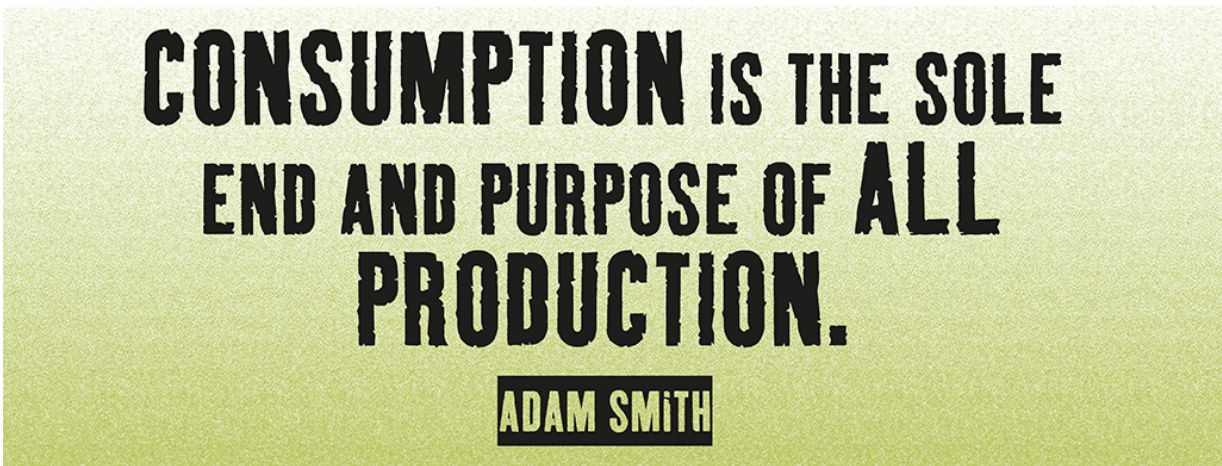


customers, we are continually being urged to consume and spend more, and this emphasis on consumption rather than production of goods is often referred to as “consumerism.” To do this, retailers have made shopping easier, by offering telephone and online purchasing, or presenting shopping as a pleasurable activity rather than a chore.



Life's little luxuries

In rich countries, more people have money to spare after buying the essentials and can afford to spend on things they want, rather than need. In addition to buying goods that give them pleasure, people spend money on services. These include things like laundry and cleaning, or hairdressing and beauty treatments, that previously they would have done for themselves. As a result, people also have more leisure time, which they can enjoy following their interests or relaxing. This means that they can spend money on leisure activities—for example, going on vacation or buying music, books, or computer games.